

Alexander Forrest Junior Web Developer (Self-Taught) Cape Town, South Africa

Email: alexanderwayneforrest@gmail.com

GitHub: <https://github.com/CaptainAlex1299>

Portfolio: <https://alexanderforrest.dev> (Live projects & demos)

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Professional Summary

Persistent self-taught developer with 5+ years of hands-on project building. Started with vanilla JavaScript/PHP/SQL full-stack apps and progressed to interactive React/TypeScript applications with real-time features (e.g., Socket.IO). Strong problem-solver focused on shipping functional, responsive websites. Currently preparing for Oracle Certified Professional (OCP) Java SE to expand into backend/enterprise roles. Seeking a junior web/full-stack developer position in Cape Town to contribute reliable code, learn quickly, and grow in a team.

Key Projects

- **Tic-Tac-Toe Multiplayer** | March 2025 Real-time multiplayer game with private rooms and live updates. Built with React, TypeScript, and Socket.IO. Demonstrates state management, WebSockets, and interactive UI. GitHub: [Repo link if available] | Live: [Add if deployed]
- **Weather App** | February 2025 Real-time weather dashboard fetching data from a public API. Built with React and custom CSS for responsive design.
- **To-Do List** | February 2025 Task management app with filtering, sorting, and local storage persistence. Built with React and JavaScript.
- **Calculator** | February 2025 Advanced calculator with operations, history, and dark mode toggle. Built with React and JavaScript.
- **PlantParadise** | February 2023 – August 2023 Responsive plant exploration app with category browsing (e.g., Indoor/Outdoor, Large/Small), care tips, and SA shipping info. Built with HTML, CSS (heavy styling), minimal JavaScript, and PHP. Early UI experimentation project—messy code but functional. Live: <https://alexanderforrest.dev/PlantParadise> GitHub: <https://github.com/CaptainAlex1299/Plant-Paradise>
- **Butcher's Circus** | January 2022 – January 2023 First major full-stack project: Community platform for tracking tournament leaderboards, fixtures, player stats, and news. Built with vanilla JavaScript, PHP, SQL, and CSS. Took 6-8 months of self-directed effort—messy code (no Git initially), but completed a data-driven app. Live: <https://alexanderforrest.dev/BCPL/> GitHub: <https://github.com/CaptainAlex1299/BCPL>
- **Reaction Tester** | January 2022 Sci-fi themed reaction time game with animations. Built with vanilla JavaScript and CSS.

Professional Experience

Self-Taught Web Development Projects | 2022 – Present Independent building of 7+ live web apps, focusing on responsive design, interactivity, API integration, and continuous skill improvement through experimentation and online resources.

Waiter / Petrol Attendant | Various Roles – 2020–2022 Part-time positions while transitioning into tech. Developed strong communication, time management, and customer service skills in fast-paced environments.

Education & Certifications

- **Oracle Certified Professional (OCP) Java SE** – In preparation (self-study via Oracle resources, Udemy, and practice exams)
- **The Complete Web Developer Course** – Udemy
- **Introduction to Programming** – Boston College
- Ongoing self-directed learning: YouTube, official documentation, project-based practice

Technical Skills

Frontend: React, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS **Backend:** PHP, SQL, basic Node.js **Tools:** Git, GitHub, VS Code, REST APIs **Soft Skills:** Problem-solving, persistence, attention to detail, fast learner through grit